

Texas WIC Health and Human Services Commission

Effective November 1, 2025

Policy No. CS:08.0

Adjunctive Income Eligibility

Purpose

To allow automatic income eligibility for the WIC Program for those applicants who are determined to be adjunctively income eligible.

Authority

7 CFR Part 246.7; 26 TAC 366.3

Policy

An applicant for WIC is adjunctively income eligible when the applicant is:

1. Certified as fully eligible to receive Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) benefits.
2. Certified as fully eligible for Temporary Assistance to Needy Families (TANF).
3. Certified as fully eligible or presumptively eligible for Medicaid.
4. Certified as fully eligible for the Healthy Texas Women Program (HTW).
5. A member of a household in which any eligible participant is certified as fully eligible to receive assistance under TANF.
6. A member of a household in which a pregnant woman or an infant is certified as fully or presumptively eligible to receive Medicaid.

Definitions

Adjunctive income eligibility – is the determination of income eligibility for WIC based on a person's or their household members' participation in the Medicaid, SNAP, or TANF program.

Automated Voice Response System (AVR) – is a telephone service operated by the Texas Health and Human Services Commission (HHSC) and is

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available 24 hours a day through a toll-free number. The AVR has voice recognition, which identifies and interprets spoken language. A WIC applicant may contact 2-1-1 or 877-541-7905 for verification that they actively receive Medicaid, SNAP, or TANF benefits. Applicants should note that this line is busiest between 11:00 AM and 3:00 PM, and particularly during the first week of each month when benefits are mailed.

A Lone Star Card – is issued to a TANF or SNAP recipient for electronic benefits transfer (EBT). The Lone Star Card is not acceptable proof of participation in TANF or SNAP as possessing a card or showing the monetary balance on the card does not indicate the person or their household member is actively receiving SNAP or TANF benefits.

Household – all persons, related or unrelated, living together in the same dwelling, except for the following special situations: foster child, individuals who qualify as a separate economic unit, and residents of a homeless facility or other residential institution. Participation in one of the three adjunctive programs for an infant/child placed by the Department of Family and Protective Services (DFPS) must not be used by another member of the foster family's household for adjunctive income eligibility.

Healthy Texas Women (HTW) – provides limited Medicaid-paid women's health and family planning benefits to women ages 15-44 with income at or below 204.2 percent of the federal poverty level. For HTW applicants aged 15-17, a parent or legal guardian must apply on their behalf. Only citizens and some immigrants are eligible. Benefits include an annual family planning exam and choice of contraception for 12 months. A pregnant woman is not eligible for HTW and therefore HTW certification cannot be used to qualify other members of the household for WIC. For more information go to [Healthy Texas Women](#).

A SNAP recipient – is one or more person who purchases and prepares food together and meets the SNAP program financial and non-financial eligibility

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requirements. HHSC mails most SNAP forms to the person indicated as the head of the household (HOH) in the SNAP case record.

Presumptive eligibility – is a status in which short-term Medicaid coverage is provided to individuals determined potentially eligible for regular Medicaid by a qualified hospital or a qualified entity. This coverage is provided temporarily while HHSC determines eligibility for regular Medicaid. A presumptive eligibility determination provides full Medicaid coverage for children under age 19, former foster care children, Medicaid for Breast and Cervical Cancer (MBCC) applicants, and parents and other caretaker relatives. It also provides coverage for prenatal ambulatory services only for pregnant women. Once the application process is complete, if the individual is not eligible for regular Medicaid, presumptive eligibility coverage ends on the date that HHSC determines the individual is ineligible.

WIC regulations allow a client presumptively eligible for Medicaid to be considered income eligible for WIC benefits. After WIC certification, the client is not required to prove they were subsequently certified as fully eligible for Medicaid. There is no presumptive eligibility for SNAP, TANF, or the HTW Program.

Your Texas Benefits Medicaid Card – is issued to each person who participates in the Medicaid program. This is not acceptable proof of current participation in Medicaid because the card does not reflect eligibility periods. Therefore, staff must verify participation in the Medicaid program as described in Procedure I.B. of this policy.

Texas Medicaid and Healthcare Partnership (TMHP) – is a secure portal to verify enrollment in Medicaid.

Health and Human Services (HHS) Outreach Report – a list of potentially eligible clients who are:

- Adjunctively eligible (Medicaid, SNAP, and TANF)
- Categorically eligible

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- Unduplicated (i.e., not a current WIC participant)
- This report serves as proof of adjunctive eligibility for a three-month period, beginning with the month listed on the report (this is the month participant is 'certified' as adjunctively eligible).

Provisional Certification – a 30-day certification and up to 30-days benefit issuance for an applicant/participant who meets all eligibility criteria at certification but fails to bring one of the acceptable proofs of identification, residency, or income.

Disaster Expedited Certification – a certification process where anthropometrics and blood work are optional but must be obtained within 90 days from certification. This is allowed during a disaster situation.

Procedures

- I. When determining income eligibility, staff must inquire if the applicant is fully eligible to receive SNAP or TANF benefits, or fully or presumptively eligible to receive regular Medicaid benefits.

If the applicant is not eligible for benefits from one of these three adjunctive programs, the LA must inquire if the applicant is a member of a household in which a member is fully eligible to receive TANF or a member of a household in which a pregnant woman or an infant is full or presumptively eligible to receive Medicaid.

- A. Adjunctive eligibility must be determined at each certification.
- B. Current status must be determined by one of the following options:
1. Any available adjunct query in the Management Information System (MIS).
 2. Visual review of acceptable documentation when provided by the participant.
 - a. Form TF0001, Notice of Case Action indicates each person certified for Medicaid, SNAP, and TANF. The HOH or any

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responsible adult household member can obtain a copy of their Form TF0001 by calling 2-1-1 or accessing their Your Texas Benefits online account.

- b. Documents obtained via electronic transmission are automatically saved in MIS.
- 3. LA staff may inquire by on-line computer system (TMHP) for the Medicaid program when an applicant cannot provide documentation of their current eligibility status or presents their Your Texas Benefits Card (YTBC).
- 4. A WIC applicant can contact the AVR by calling 2-1-1 or 877-541-7905 for verification that they actively receive Medicaid, SNAP, and TANF.
- 5. Staff may verify through the HHS Outreach Report.
- C. Documentation from only one of the three adjunctive programs is required per applicant. Check the box under 'Is Proof available?' to indicate the eligible program(s). Participant Enrollment number (client ID or case number – HHS Outreach or enter 55555555 if unknown) must be entered for the program used for eligibility. A copy of the electronic document is not required for the participant's file.
- D. Participation in the HTW Program is documented as Medicaid. HTW eligibility can only be used for adjunctive income eligibility by postpartum and breastfeeding women.
- E. Applicants eligible to receive SNAP benefits must provide one of the following:
 - 1. Proof showing the applicant himself/herself is eligible to receive such benefits. Minors applying for themselves who reside with their parents and provide proof the parent is eligible to receive SNAP benefits (LA staff must verbally inquire if the applicant is

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eligible to receive SNAP) must be considered adjunctively income eligible as they are considered in the economic unit.

2. Proof showing the parent or guardian applying on behalf of an infant or child receives such benefits for himself/herself or any household member. If the other household members are not certified to receive SNAP benefits, the LA staff must determine if the household members are eligible under another adjunctive program or follow procedures of [CS:07.0 Income Screening as a Certification Requirement](#).
- F. Applicants who are eligible to receive TANF or are fully or presumptively eligible to receive Medicaid benefits as applicable must provide proof. LA staff must accept Medicaid proof for a participant regardless of who is listed as the parent or guardian or regardless of Department of Family and Protective Services (DFPS) Placement of the infant or child.
- G. Applicants applying for WIC based on a household member's eligibility for TANF or Medicaid must provide one of the following:
 1. Proof showing a pregnant woman or infant household member as a Medicaid recipient or the household member's eligibility for TANF.

Note: A pregnant woman can provide any current acceptable proof of Medicaid coverage to qualify another member in the household. The Medicaid coverage does not have to specify that it is Medicaid for Pregnant Women. A pregnant woman's WIC eligibility based on pregnant Medicaid ends on the last day of the second month following the month the pregnancy ends; therefore, her infant could be determined to be eligible based on the mother's Medicaid until two months of age. The infant's presumptive eligibility may be used to adjunctively certify other household members. A fully eligible infant may also adjunctively qualify other household members. The infant

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and other household members must be certified for a full certification period.

2. Proof showing the applicant resides with the TANF or Medicaid recipient:
 - a. Applicant's or parent/guardian's proof of address (utility bill, etc.) must match the address of the TANF or Medicaid recipient whose name is listed on the form; or
 - b. If the adult applying for herself or a child does not have proof that their address matches the address of the TANF or Medicaid recipient, the adult must provide a signed written statement confirming residency. Staff must upload the signed written statement to the Family Page.
- II. Persons determined income eligible for WIC under this policy must meet the eligibility criteria for program participation outlined in [CS:01.0 \(T\) Eligibility Criteria for Program Participation](#).
- III. Provisional Certification (30 days) may be offered to an applicant who does not provide one of the three required proofs (income eligibility, residency, and identification) at the time of the certification appointment but meets all other eligibility criteria and applicable documentation requirements.
 - A. If the applicant/parent/applicant/parent/guardian meets all other eligibility requirements:
 1. The MIS will allow up to 30-day benefit issuance.
 2. If the applicant/parent/guardian returns with the correct proof within 30 days and is found eligible, the MIS will establish the full certification period.
 3. If the applicant does not return within 30 days with the correct proof, the applicant is ineligible and automatically terminated by the MIS.

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- B. Staff cannot issue a second or subsequent Provisional Certification if the applicant fails to provide the required documentation within the 30 days (i.e., two “back-to-back” provisional certifications that would equate to 60 days of continuous provisional certification is not allowed). If a participant receives a provisional certification and that certification is followed by a full certification, or if a minimum of 6 months has passed since the last provisional certification was issued to the participant, the participant will be eligible for a second provisional certification.
- IV. Staff must document in the MIS the household size and inquire with the applicant the verbally declared monthly income on the participants determined adjunctively eligible. Applicants are not required to provide proof of income, such as paycheck stubs, tax records, or bank statements, etc. The applicant is still adjunctively income eligible even if their income exceeds the WIC income guidelines.
- V. Staff must document participation in all adjunctive programs in the MIS for each applicant. Analysis of this data will be used by the United States Department of Agriculture (USDA). (Note: A copy of the adjunctive program document is not required.) VI. The LA is not required to verify the continued eligibility of the participant in their respective adjunctive program(s) during the current WIC certification period.
- VI. If the participant applies for subsequent certification at the end of the current WIC certification period and is not adjunctively income eligible the applicant must be screened in accordance with [CS:07.0 Income Screening as a Certification Requirement](#) for income eligibility.
- VII. Participants are not required to report income changes within certification periods nor are LAs required to inquire about such changes. However, during a certification period, if the LA receives information from any party regarding a change in adjunct eligibility, the LA must conduct a reassessment of program eligibility during the certification period unless the information concerns possible program fraud or

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abuse. When a LA suspects that a participant is engaging in program fraud or abuse at any time during the certification period, refer to [GA:12.0 \(T\) Participant Violations](#) for instructions on reporting to the state agency. Reassessments are not required when there are 90 days or less before the expiration of the certification period. If the individual is determined ineligible, the LA must disqualify the individual and any other family members participating in WIC at the time of the reassessment.

- A. Some examples of situations that trigger a mandatory reassessment when using adjunctive eligibility through Medicaid, SNAP or TANF include:
 - 1. Household member certified, and adjunctive eligibility has changed; or
 - 2. A change in custody, excluding DFPS placements.
- B. The participant must provide proof of their continued eligibility in the Medicaid, SNAP or TANF program or proof of their income to their next appointment:
 - 1. WIC staff must issue one month of benefits and require the person to provide written documentation at the next appointment and schedule the next appointment within the month.
 - 2. If the client fails to provide proof of continued participation in the adjunctive program or proof of income, the individual and any other household members participating in WIC at the time of the reassessment must be disqualified from the Program.
 - 3. Any reassessment must determine:
 - a. If the person is certified as eligible to participate in either Medicaid, SNAP or TANF programs; or
 - b. If the individual is a member of a household that contains a person certified as eligible to receive TANF, or is a member of

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a household in which a pregnant woman or an infant is fully or presumptively eligible to receive Medicaid; or

c. If the individual is income eligible under the procedures of [CS:07.0 Income Screening as a Certification Requirement](#).

C. Medicaid does not need to be reassessed if Medicaid benefits remain in the participant's name.